Start: letters a m s t · lesson 6 of 8 · 50 minutes

First Sounds: I Spy a m s t

Today your child learns: I can hear the first sound in a word and show its letter.



Standards: RF.K.2, RF.K.3a, RF.K.3b, RF.K.1d, RF.K.1a, RF.K.1b, RF.K.1c, L.K.1a, 10.5 K.A, 10.5 K.B, 10.5 K.C. Common Core State Standards © 2010 NGA Center and CCSSO.

10′ Sounds · 3′ Letters · 20′ New · 7′ Read · 10′ Write

Today at a glance

10 min	Sound games: say a word, catch its first sound; stand-up /s/ round.
3 min	Letter drill: small letter cards, then the capital cards; name, sound, key picture.
20 min	I Spy with kit cards, then First Sounds sheet rows m, s, t alone.
7 min	Reading together: Happy, Happy Home; start top left, finger under each word.
10 min	Handwriting sheet: say the path, trace 3, write 1 of a m s t.

Get ready (2 minutes)

- Print: First Sounds: a m s t
- Print: Handwriting: a m s t, day 8
- From the kit: a m s t letter cards, picture cards, trace pages
- Happy, Happy Home book (printed once, reused days 8-10)
- Pencil and a crayon

Printing in black and white? The green start dot is the big dot.

Tip for the grown-up

Say stop sounds like /t/ as a quick whisper, never tuh, hold stretchy ones like /m/ and /s/, and if your child gives a letter name, smile and ask: That is its name; what sound does it make? From today, the extra minutes from the start-of-year check begin: Nearly gets 3 minutes with index cards on a ring, Not yet gets 5 minutes in a small group (at home, just you and your child).



Short on time? At home in 20 minutes

1. 3 minutes: flash the kit a m s t small letter cards, then the capital cards; your child says name, sound and key picture.
2. 5 minutes: say melon, soap, tiger, tummy, sail and animal, stretching the start, and your child says each first sound.
3. 6 minutes: play I Spy with the kit picture cards, then do the First Sounds: a m s t sheet, naming each picture once.
4. 3 minutes: read Happy, Happy Home with your finger under each word; your child finds one a, m, s or t.
5. 3 minutes: on the handwriting sheet, say each path aloud while your child traces 3 and writes 1 of each letter.

SOUND GAMES

Sound Games: Catch the First Sound

10 min

Hear and say the first sound of a spoken word, with no letters.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Listen. Mmmelon. The first sound in melon is /m/.

Sssoap. The first sound in soap is /s/.

Tiger. That one is quick: /t/. Tiger starts with /t/.

- Stretch /m/ and /s/; say /t/ as a quick whisper, never with an uh.
- Hold up one finger each time you say the first sound.

We do together

SAY

Say mask with me. Mmmask. First sound? /m/!

Sister. Sssister. First sound? /s/!

After. /a/ /a/ after. First sound? /a/!

- Say each word together, stretch the first sound, then say it alone with one finger up.
- Pause just before the first sound so the child says it with you.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Tummy. What is the first sound?

Sail. Animal. Moose. What is the first sound?

Stand up if it starts with /s/: silly, nose, sofa, duck.

- Say each word once and wait 3 seconds. Answers: /t/, /s/, /a/, /m/.
- Child stands for silly and sofa, stays seated for nose and duck.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: tummy, /t/. Our turn: /t/. Your turn: tummy, first sound?
- Letter name instead? Say: That is its name. What sound does it make?

LETTER DRILL

Letter Drill: a m s t

3 min

Say the name, sound and key picture for a, m, s, t, small and capital.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

This is the letter m. It says /m/, like map.

This is the letter t. It says /t/, quick, like top.

- Hold up each kit letter card with its key picture: apple, map, sun, top.
- Hold /a/, /m/ and /s/ long; whisper /t/ quick.

We do together

SAY

Together: letter a, /a/, apple.

Now the capital card. Capital A, /a/, apple.

- Any sound not ticked on Friday's check goes first today, as the day 5 sheet promised.
- Run all 4 together: small letter cards, then the capital cards.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Name, sound, picture.

- Shuffle and flash the small letter cards, then the capital cards. Child says name, sound and key picture.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: letter s, /s/, sun. Our turn. Your turn.
- If you hear tuh, say: Quick and quiet, /t/. Try again.

NEW SKILL

I Spy First Sounds

20 min

Hear the first sound of a word and match it to the letter a, m, s or t.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

I spy something that starts with /m/. Mmmoon! Moon starts with /m/.

Turtle. Its first sound is /t/. I hold up the letter t.

Dog. /d/. That is not a, m, s or t. Back it goes.

- Lay the 4 kit letter cards in a row; spread 8 kit picture cards below them.
- Set moon under m and turtle under t; put dog back.

We do together

SAY

Spy with me. I spy something that starts with /s/.

Sssock! Say it together: /s/, sock. Which letter? Hold it up!

Sheet, row one: ambulance, dog, ax, fish. Circle the /a/ ones.

- Spy ant, sock, mop and ten; child finds each card and holds up its letter card.
- Do row a together: circle ambulance and ax; say why dog and fish do not fit.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn alone: rows m, s and t.

I say each picture once. Circle the two that start with the row's sound.

Milk, bed, cake, mug. Which two start with /m/?

- Name the 4 pictures in each row once, left to right; the child circles 2.
- Check with the answer key: milk, mug; sink, saw; tie, tub.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: mmmilk, /m/. Our turn: milk, /m/. Your turn: does bed start with /m/?
- If stuck, stretch the word slowly and hold up one finger on the first sound.

READING TOGETHER

Reading together: Happy, Happy Home

7 min

Track print left to right and top to bottom, see spaces between words, and spot a m s t.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

I start here, at the top, on the left.

My finger goes under each word: Happy. Happy. Home.

Three words, with spaces between. Home has the letter m in it.

- Read the title slowly, finger under each word, pausing on each space.
- Read each page aloud; sweep left to right, then drop to the next line.

We do together

SAY

Show me where I start reading on this page.

Read with me. Your finger goes under each word with mine.

Turn the page. Where do we go next?

- Child puts a finger at the top left; read together, your voice leading.
- Child turns each page; stop twice to ask where to go next.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Find a letter we know: a, m, s or t.

What sound does that letter make?

Point under each word in this line while I read.

- Child finds one known letter on a page and says its sound, not the word.
- Child points under each word as you read one line; watch for the jump at spaces.

If your child gets it wrong

- My turn: I start at the top left and go this way. Our turn. Your turn.
- If the finger runs ahead, slow down: one word, one tap.

HANDWRITING

Handwriting: a m s t Review

10 min

Write small a, m, s and t with the right start and stroke order.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

a: Start just below the middle line. Circle back all the way around.

Push up to the middle line and pull straight down. m: Start at the middle line.

Pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down.

- Pinch and flip. Write a, m, s, t big; read the s and t paths from the box.
- Start a and s just below the middle line, m on it, t near the top.

We do together

SAY

Stand up. Write a in the air with me, big. Say the path.

Now m, s and t. Say each path with me.

Let's trace the first a on the sheet together.

- Air-write each letter with a straight arm, saying the exact path together.
- Trace the first letter in each row together, saying the path.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Trace 3, then write one alone from the green dot.

Say the path while you write.

Circle your best letter in each row.

- Child traces 3 of each letter and writes 1 alone; kit trace pages sit nearby as models.
- Watch start point, direction and the t cross on the middle line, not neatness.

Letter paths: say these words as you write

- **a** Start just below the middle line. Circle back all the way around. Push up to the middle line and pull straight down.
- **m** Start at the middle line. Pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down. Push up, curve over, pull down.
- **s** Start just below the middle line. Curve back, then curve forward, like a snake.
- **t** Start near the top line. Pull straight down. Cross at the middle line: slide right.

If your child gets it wrong

- Wrong start or direction? My turn on the line, our turn hand over hand, your turn.
- If the grip slips, say: Pinch and flip. Then try that letter again.

Quick check (2 minutes)

1. Say toy, then sip; the child says each first sound (/t/, /s/).
2. Say ask; the child says the first sound, /a/.
3. Hold up the m and t kit letter cards; the child says each sound (5 answers in all).

Got it

5 right: tomorrow do the cut-and-glue sort as written, plus a challenge: first sounds of family names.

Nearly

3 or 4 right: tomorrow add 2 minutes of I Spy with only the missed sounds (at home: just you and your child).

Not yet

0 to 2 right: tomorrow add 3 extra minutes (in class a small group, at home just you and your child): my turn, our turn, your turn with melon, soap, tiger and the letter cards.